PROJECT MILESTONES - 24 months, 1 March 2027 to 28 February 2029

Fungal and microbial colonisation of tropical educational building exteriors: molecular characterisation and campus air-quality context at UTS Sibu
Dr Armstrong Ighodalo Omoregie | BERI, School of Built Environment, UTS | UTS Matching Grant, Cycle 1/2027

Phase 1 — Mar - May 2027

- SORAS application for the SBC permit submitted on commencement; permit issued
- Four buildings stratified by facade material, age, design approach and exposure
- 36 fixed sampling points established, georeferenced and photographed
- Facade material and shading inventory, and baseline algal and cyanobacterial cover survey, complete
- Monitoring nodes fabricated and calibrated against the rented reference instrument
- Sampling, culture and contamination-control protocols agreed with SRDC-TROPI and validated

Phase 2 — Jun 2027 - Sep 2028

- R1 Jun 2027, R2 Sep 2027, R3 Dec 2027, R4 Mar 2028, R5 Jun 2028, R6 Sep 2028
- Haze-triggered supplementary rounds as episodes arise
- Nodes installed; cloud platform, public dashboard and display unit live by Sep 2027
- Algal and cyanobacterial cover plus microclimate covariates recorded at every point, every round
- Field, transport and extraction blanks collected each round

Phase 3 — Jun 2027 - Dec 2028

- Rolling cold-chain transfer of inoculated plates to SRDC-TROPI, one round at a time
- Incubation, CFU enumeration, morphotyping, isolation and purification at SRDC-TROPI
- Interim community profile at twelve months (Jun 2028)
- DNA extraction and ITS PCR; Sanger identification of the curated 60-isolate set
- Blanks processed and reported alongside each batch; isolate collection curated

Phase 4 — Oct 2028 - Feb 2029

- Full seasonal and year-on-year statistical and community analysis
- First indexed manuscript submitted (Nov 2028)
- Exterior material selection and maintenance guidance issued
- Campus air-quality reporting protocol issued; sequences deposited with accessions
- Second indexed manuscript submitted (Feb 2029)
- Final project report and grant closure via URCMS by 28 Feb 2029

Fixed 24-month term, no extension. Sampling closes Sep 2028 and molecular work Dec 2028 so that the closing months carry only analysis, writing, dissemination and closure. The first sampling round follows issue of the SBC permit.